they established a Boundary Committee. Before that, in April 1958, the foreign ministry had instructed the provinces and autonomous regions to furnish relevant materials. Later that year, the leadership noted China's 'limited knowledge about the frontiers, and the lack of historical materials, diplomatic files and accurate maps of the boundary lines'.[42] We should remember that China had been at war from 1937, even before Europe. As Rana Mitter, the Oxford University historian, notes, Chinese civilian and military deaths during this time amounted to 14 million, second only to the 40 million dead in the USSR.[43] In these circumstances, it is quite plausible that Chinese data was fragmented and difficult to pull together – some of it may have been taken away by the Kuomintang to Taiwan as well.

Domestics politics too may have constrained both leaderships and may account for why Delhi and Beijing changed their stances in confounding ways. In the case of Nehru there was opposition within the Congress, within Parliament, in the media, and on the streets. In his history of post-Independence India, Ramachandra Guha recounts the growing domestic opposition to Nehru's China policy from about 1959 to the outbreak of war in 1962. This included the public quarrel between Defence Minister V.K. Krishna Menon and Chief of Army Staff General K.S. Thimayya which led the latter to hand in his resignation. The civil–military quarrel led to demands in the press for Menon's resignation. Even members of Nehru's Congress party asked for Menon's removal.[44] By late 1959, in the wake of the Longju and Kongka Pass border incidents and with the publication of India's White Paper on the border problem, the press and public opinion were further inflamed. On 4 November 1959, one hundred Congress members of Parliament (MPs) met Nehru to communicate their disquiet over China. Srinath Raghavan notes that though Nehru argued against a hardening of policy, the delegation was 'not satisfied with these explanations'. Erstwhile political colleagues such as C. Rajagopalachari and Jaiprakash Narayan joined in the criticism of Nehru's policies.[45]

Guha quotes an Indian paper as saying Nehru stood 'alone against the rising tide of national resentment against China'.[46] In January 1960, the opposition Jana Sangh asked for 'action to free Indian soil from Chinese